Jeter Cotton

Director of Project Management | Agency Delivery & Operations | AI Workflow Automation
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Summary

Project management leader with nearly 9 years of agency experience, growing from Project Manager to Director and building the PM function from the ground up. Now runs delivery for 60+ clients (about $4M per year) with a team of 3 PMs. Happiest turning messy operations into simple systems, like cutting non-billable hours by 20%+ and building 9 AI agents that handle utilization reporting and flag at-risk clients early.

Experience

Primitive | Lubbock, TX · December 2017 - Present

Marketing and digital services agency · 30+ employees · 60+ active clients

Director of Project Management · November 2025 - Present

- Lead the agency's project management function, setting how work is planned, staffed, and delivered across 60+ client engagements, and partnering with executive leadership on staffing and process priorities.
- Manage and develop the PM team, owning performance reviews, documentation, and personnel issues, and build hiring cases from time-tracking data.
- Lead a company-wide work planning rebuild, redesigning task setup and team communication and running planning sessions with department leads.
- Own sprint process standards, restructuring retros and sprint planning so team leads own them.
- Run monthly and sprint-level billable utilization analysis against the 80% company goal, backed by automated weekly utilization and non-billable reports.
- Own the agency's ClickUp architecture (task templates, naming conventions, status workflows, intake, and priority definitions) and run daily task hygiene audits for client operations.
- Build and test AI agents and skills, including a 90-day task loader and a churn-tracking skill.
- Audit scope by reconciling project data against time tracking, and check proposals against the task template library for fit with retainer tiers.
- Write SOPs and How We Work standards, including sprint planning, status, and work-change definitions, and maintain the client knowledge base structure.

Lead Project Manager · July 2024 - November 2025

- Cut non-billable hours by over 20% after rebuilding capacity planning and work assignment across 19 billable team members (about 1,100 hours of capacity per sprint).
- Designed the Client Sentiment Monitor, an AI agent that scores 56 accounts weekly from chats, task comments, and email. It caught a $16.6K/month retainer in time to pull it back from red to yellow.

- Built 9 AI agents in ClickUp and Claude that handle utilization reporting, billable-time audits, sprint rollovers, time-tracking reminders, meeting notes, and project intake, saving the team 15+ hours per week of manual admin.
- Built the PM department from zero, defining roles, the intake-to-delivery workflow, and performance metrics now used by 30+ staff across 7 departments.
- Led the company-wide move from Slack to ClickUp Chat for 30+ employees in about 6 weeks, using internal champions, short training videos, and a dedicated support channel. Client channels stayed live the whole time.
- Rebuilt web project delivery into a 7-phase, 39-step process with 5 client approval gates and automatic escalation after 3 revision rounds. Adopted company-wide, it ended ad hoc handoffs and wasted copy rework.

Lead Account Manager · November 2022 - July 2024

- Managed 40 client accounts worth about $1.14M a year as the main contact for strategy, scope, and escalations.
- Kept 95% of accounts year over year and landed about 10 upsells and scope expansions worth $50K combined.

Product Owner/Senior Product Owner · September 2020 - November 2022

- Owned the backlog and roadmap for 35 software and website projects, leading a 6-person team (content strategist, copywriter, designer, and 3 developers) in 1-week sprints.
- Shipped about 70 releases, 90% of them on time, and was promoted to Senior Product Owner within 19 months.
- Standardized how projects were structured and set up time tracking by discipline (strategy, copy, design, development), giving the team its first clear view of where hours went.

Project Manager · December 2017 - September 2020

- Delivered about 65 client projects a year, with budgets up to $15K, 90% on time and on budget.
- Introduced consistent time tracking across project teams, something the agency had never done before.

Redeemer Church & Indiana Avenue Baptist Church | Lubbock, TX · 2013 - 2017
Technical Director & A/V Coordinator

- Ran weekly live production (audio, lighting, video, and livestream), trained a volunteer crew of 20+, and wrote the SOPs that kept it consistent.

Skills

Expertise: Portfolio Management, Resource Management, Capacity Planning, Agile/Scrum, Scope & Budget Management, Risk Management, Stakeholder Management, PMO Setup, Process Improvement, Change Management, KPI & Utilization Reporting, AI Workflow Automation, Team Leadership & Hiring

Tools: ClickUp, Jira, Asana, HubSpot, Claude, Google Workspace, Figma

Education

Associate of Applied Science, Sound Technology — South Plains College · May 2014